

THAT FRIEND

GENRE

RUNTIME

PRODUCTION

IMDB

Comedy / Bromance 90 min Bolo / Straw Hut Media [t33041195](#)

Logline

When Paul crashes his best friend Henry's romantic weekend in Palm Springs with his new girlfriend Penny, what starts as an innocent visit spirals into mayhem after Paul's drug-laced cigarettes disappear into a stranger's hands.

Synopsis

That Friend is an indie bromance comedy about Paul (Harvey Guillén) — you know, that friend whose invitation for “one drink” seems harmless but inevitably leads to chaotic consequences.

When Paul crashes his best friend Henry's (Josh Brener) romantic weekend in Palm Springs with his new girlfriend Penny (Billie Lourd), what starts as an innocent visit spirals into mayhem after Paul's drug-laced cigarettes disappear into a stranger's hands.

Written and directed by the filmmaking duo Alex Wall and Will Sterling in their feature debut, this film explores the hilarious and complex dynamics of friendship, loyalty, and the chaos we create for the people we love most.



Directors' Statement

At its core, *That Friend* is about the person in your life who always makes things messier, louder, and more complicated than you wanted, but who you just can't seem to let go of. We've both had those people. In fact, at some point, we've both been those people.

Comedy is often rooted in chaos, but what drew us to this story was the tension beneath the laughs: what do you do when a lifelong friendship that once felt indestructible starts to feel toxic? When it starts getting in the way of the life you want for yourself? How do you separate love from obligation, nostalgia from reality? Those questions gave us a way to explore friendship, love, codependency, and emotional growth, while still letting things spiral into the kind of absurd, drug fueled, wild night level of fun that this story lives in.

We wanted the film to feel like a night out with that friend, unpredictable, hilarious, exhausting, and ultimately revealing of a truth that is almost impossible to acknowledge. The goal wasn't just to capture the hijinks, but to sit in the morning after, the hangover where you wonder if maybe it's time to change.

Making this film together as longtime friends ourselves, we channeled our own histories into the DNA of these characters. *That Friend* is loud and chaotic on the surface, but at its core is a love letter to complicated friendships, the kind that shape us, frustrate us, and, in the end, teach us who we really are.



Filmmakers



Wall

DIRECTOR

the debut feature from Alex Wai (writer/director). His prior collaborations with Will Sterling have placed and been featured in The Poll Fellowships in Screenwriting, Newport Beach Film Festival, Paris International Film Festival, Austin Film Festival, Blue Cat Screenwriting. He edits and produces unscripted television for HBO, MAX, NBC, A&E and Netflix.



terling

DIRECTOR

is the second feature from writer, director, actor, producer Will Sterling, whose work blends sharp comedy with strong emotional and genre driven storytelling. His meta-comedy “A Cell Phone Movie” was nominated for Best Debut Feature at the Raindance Film 5, and his debut novel “Fame by Misadventure” won Best Fiction in the 2024 National Indie Excellence Awards.



Ryan Tillotson

PRODUCER

Tillotson is the founder and CEO of acclaimed podcast house Straw Hut Media that partners with Hulu, Netflix, Universal, Rotten Tomatoes, among several other companies.



el Amico

OF PHOTOGRAPHY

is a Prague-based photographer and cinematographer. With a background in documentary, he focuses on people, observing how they behave within different environments and often looking for moments of contrast within a scene. He approaches cinematography with a filmmaker's mindset—using framing, blocking, and natural light to support performance and reveal character. *That Friend* is his debut narrative feature.



Land

is an editor & assistant editor whose work spans studio films, independent features, documentaries, and television. His recent credits include *Courage Rising*, *Transformers: Rise of the Beasts*, and *Sandiwara*, the upcoming short film from Sean Baker.



Baldassero

o is a Los Angeles-based composer, producer, and artist from Toronto. His recent work includes the SXSW-premiering *Deepfaking Samers* (Georgina Campbell), and music supervision on A24's *The Undertone*. He scored the Amazon/Hulu series *Davey & Jonesie's Locker*, dian Screen Award nomination, and has contributed music to the upcoming feature *Ballistic* (Lena Headey). He is currently scoring *Team from Hell*, starring Kevin Hart and Druski.



ti Lugo

Cast



Harvey Guillén

ACTOR

Academy-nominated for his beloved role as Guillermo in “What We Do in the Shadows.”



Ellie Lourd

ACTRESS

Sister of “American Horror Story,” “Scream Queens,” and “Booksmart.”



Janelle Monáe

ACTRESS

Known for “Parks and Recreation” and “The Mindy Project.”



Miles Teller

ACTOR

Known for “The Wilds” and “The Way, Way Back.”



Mary Holland

ACTRESS

Known for “Happiest Season,” “Booksmart,” and “The Afterparty.”



Ilan Vaid-Menon

COMEDIAN

Claimed author, poet, and performer known for their comedy specials and bestselling books.



Paul Guzman

ACTOR

Actor and comedian known for his versatile performances.



Will Sterling

ACTOR

Writer and co-director of “That Friend,” also appearing as Pastor Kevin.



Josh Brener

ACTOR

Known for “Silicon Valley” and “The Internship.”



Michael Brown Jr.

ACTOR

Known for “SEAL Team” and “Straight Outta Compton.”



Lauren Lapkus

ACTRESS

Known for “Orange Is the New Black,” “The Wrong Missy,” and “Good Girls.”



Rose Abdoo

ACTRESS

Known for “Gilmore Girls,” “Reno 911!,” and “The People of Earth.”

Full Credits

WRITTEN & DIRECTED BY ALEX WALL & WILL STERLING

PRODUCED BY RYAN TILLOTSON

EXECUTIVE PRODUCER STROY HOFFMAN, LEVI CHAMBERS, STEPHEN MARKLEY

EXECUTIVE PRODUCERS HARVEY GUILLÉN, BILLIE LOURD, JOSH BRENER, RETTA

PRODUCERS ALEX WALL & WILL STERLING

CO-PRODUCER KRISTI LUGO

DIRECTOR OF PHOTOGRAPHY MICHAEL AMICO

EDITED BY JOSH LAND

MUSIC BY DILLON BALDASSERO

PRODUCTION DESIGNER LUCIA LOPEZ

WARDROBE BY DANIELLE BAZAN & MADELINE BOREHAM

CASTING DIRECTOR KRISTI LUGO

1ST ASSISTANT DIRECTOR ASHLEY ROSENBERG

Cast

PAUL HARVEY GUILLÉN

PENNY BILLIE LOURD

HENRY JOSH BRENER

CHRISTINE RETTA

BILL NEIL BROWN JR.

SPENCER MILES GUTIERREZ-RILEY

JESSA LAUREN LAPKUS

MICHELLE MARY HOLLAND

MARYANN ROSE ABDOO

BLAIR ALOK VAID-MENON

FREDRICK JIM HOFFMASTER

PASTOR KEVIN WILL STERLING

PHILLIP PAUL GUZMAN

CHRIS ALAN PETERSON

TIFFANY AISHA HOLDEN

OTHER HENRY VANCE LOVETT

BABY HENRY ALEX WALL

Additional Cast

PARTYGOER KATHARINE MANGOLD
PARTYGOER EDWARD HONG
PARTYGOER ANAND RAMPRASAD
PARTYGOER SOFIANE AÏT-KACI
PARTYGOER JASE ALAN
PARTYGOER JOSEPHINE CHANG
BONFIRE GUEST MADISON CROSS
BONFIRE GUEST CHRISTINE ARMSTRONG
BONFIRE GUEST DILLON BALDASSERO
BONFIRE GUEST MAGGIE BOLES
BONFIRE GUEST BRIANNA WONGSUPHAKPHAN
LIQUOR STORE CLERK EDGAR
PAUL'S RIDESHARE DRIVER ASHLEY ROSENBERG
PENNY'S FOOT MAGGIE BOLES

Crew

1ST ASSISTANT DIRECTOR ASHLEY ROSENBERG
SCRIPT SUPERVISOR KRISTIN RAPINCHUK
PRODUCTION COORDINATOR VANCE LOVETT
2ND UNIT DP CAMERON OWEN
CAMERA OPERATORS ARTURO OCHOA, CAMERON OWEN
1ST CAMERA ASSISTANTS JAKE O'CONNOR, CECILIA HUBBARD, ANDRE FERNANDEZ
DRONE OPERATOR MALIN HILES
DIGITAL IMAGING TECH JOSH LAND
KEY GRI PLANCE BROWN
2ND UNIT KEY GRIP KEVIN RAMIREZ
PRODUCTION SOUND MIXER DANIEL MCCOY
PRODUCTION DESIGNER LUCIA LOPEZ
WARDROBE DANIELLE BAZAN, MADELINE BOREHAM
HAIR DEPARTMENT HEAD JILL CORP
KEY HAIR STYLIST CONNIE AGAWIN
KEY MAKEUP ARTIST ROMIE MACEDO
MAKEUP ARTISTS KEAGHLAN ASHLEY, JAY QUINTANA
PRODUCTION ASSISTANTS RAELE VARGAS, BRIANNA WONGSUPHAKPHAN
ASST. TO HARVEY GUILLÉN AMADA SANCHEZ
BEHIND THE SCENE EDWARD SANDOVAL, MATT CARVER
SET PHOTOGRAPHER JORDAN REED
HEAD OF TRANSPORTATION ERIC DANSAK

Post Production

EDITED BY JOSH LAND

ASSISTANT EDITOR JOSH LAND

COMPOSER DILLON BALDASSERO

MUSIC SUPERVISOR SCARLETT MCDONALD

DIGITAL INTERMEDIATE FOTO KEM CREATIVE SERVICES

FINISHING COLORIST ALASTOR ARNOLD

FINISHING PRODUCER EMILY VAIL

VISUAL EFFECTS BENJAMIN NICHOLS

Sound — MelodyGun Studios

SOUND SUPERVISOR HAMED HOKAMZADEH, MPSE

SUPV. SOUND EDITOR / RE-REC MIXER THOMAS OUZIEL, MPSE

DIALOG EDITOR KEVIN KHOR, MPSE

FOLEY ARTIST REECE MILLER

FOLEY MIXER KRISTOPHER BRECKON

SOUND EFFECTS EDITOR AMENDA LEE

Musicians

TRUMPET KAE MURPHY

FLUTE & CLARINET KAREN NG

DRUMS & PERCUSSION MARK BALLYK

DRUMS ZACH SUTTON

BASS & GUITAR BRAD LABELLE

Catering

ANNA MARIE UGAPO

GWEN MARLOWE CATERING

LEO'S TACOS

Music

“Shake Your Groove Thing”

Peaches & Herb • Courtesy of Polydor Records / Universal Music Enterprises

“It Keeps You Running”

The Doobie Brothers • Courtesy of Rhino Entertainment / Warner Music Group

“It Keeps You Running”

Michael McDonald • Courtesy of Kobalt Music Publishing

“When They Fight, They Fight”

Grant Widmer & Edward Joyner • Rough Trade Publishing / Bank Robber Music

“Time”

Angelo De Augustine • Courtesy of Secretly Publishing / Asthmatic Kitty Records

“I Can't Explain”

Maggie Glass • Produced by Dillon Baldassero

“This Is It”

Maggie Glass • Produced by Dillon Baldassero

“Modern Love”

Maggie Glass

“True Romance”

Maggie Glass • Performed by Squarefish

“I'm That Girl”

Danielle Carr

“MP3”

Danielle Carr

“She Noticed”

Pregnant

“Wyd”

Grebes

“Time With My Baby”

Tino Drima

“Infinito Tren”

Amos Ever Hadani ft. Tula Ben Ari • Courtesy of Artlist

“Where's The Magic Gone”

Kyle Cox • Courtesy of Artlist

“Le Bon Temps”

Retrophonics • Courtesy of Artlist

“Lever De La Lune”

Dan Zeutine feat. Loren Noyman • Courtesy of Artlist

“Limitless ZISO Remix”

Ziso • Courtesy of Artlist

“Harmony Rush”

Alex MakeMusic • Courtesy of Artlist

“Hi”

Kawauso • Courtesy of Artlist

“Miss Lindy”

Larry and The Lamp Lighters • Courtesy of Artlist

“End Of The Line”

Roy Young • Courtesy of Artlist

“Your & I”

Benjamin Esterlis • Courtesy of Artlist

“Positive Persistent Pluck Sequence 2”

Artlist Music Logos • Courtesy of Artlist

Thank You

MICHAEL MCDONALD • KACEY SHORT • TARA ROY • MAGGIE BOLES • MOTHER EARTH BREWING • PIZZA PORT BREWING •
CARVER DISERENS • SONJA O'HARA • JEFF DEVERETT • JAY KOGEN • CAROLINE MENDOZA • ANA CLARA • ALI AHMED •
DANIELLE CARR • MADISON CROSS • ALAN PETERSON • NIKKI GROTON • PAUL COLEMAN • RACHEL PAULSON • KAYLEEN CASEY
• MICHAELANGELO MACIAS • CARRIE FRAZIER • JESSICA THOMPSON • CONNOR SIMPSON • KATRINA BITNER • BENJAMIN
NICHOLS • CHRISTINE ARMSTRONG • STEPHEN MARKLEY • ANAND RAMPRASAD • IAN ROBERTSON • DAVID PERGOLINI •
NICHOLAS YBARRA • JASE ALLEN • KATIE MCCUEN • DAVE BURG • DEAN LIAO • KEAYVA MITCHELL • CHRISTIAN BLADT • XAVIER
MONTESINOS • ALEXANDRA MONTESINOS • KRISTI AVILA • RAJEEV DASSANI • CALIFORNIA STATE UNIVERSITY AT LONG BEACH •
THE WRITERS OF FANTASY FOOTBALL LEAGUE • ADAM MOORE • MARTIN WRIGHT • RYAN BEARDSLEY • MARK HANNA • EMMETT
RUSSELL • JAMES LOSTLEN • GEORGE ZAKKOUR • JENNIFER JAKOB SCELZI • DAVID HOLECHEK • DANIEL HOLECHEK • BEN COX
• ALEXANDER JEFFREY • GREG HOLLANDER • BO YOUNGBLOOD

Tech Specs

COUNTRY OF PRODUCTION — United States

RUNNING TIME — 90 Minutes

ORIGINAL LANGUAGE — English

SHOOTING FORMAT — Digital, Color — Two Arri Alexa Minis

Filmed on Location

Palm Springs, California

San Bernardino County, California

Desert Hot Springs, California

Los Angeles, California

Equipment Provided by

Lightstone Rentals • Bright Orange Productions • Straw Hut Media • Lars Lindstrom • Bokeh Rentals • The Fun Ton Grip and
Lighting • Lance Brown



Press

BILLIE LOURD JOINS 'THAT FRIEND' COMEDY MOVIE

deadline.com • October 2024

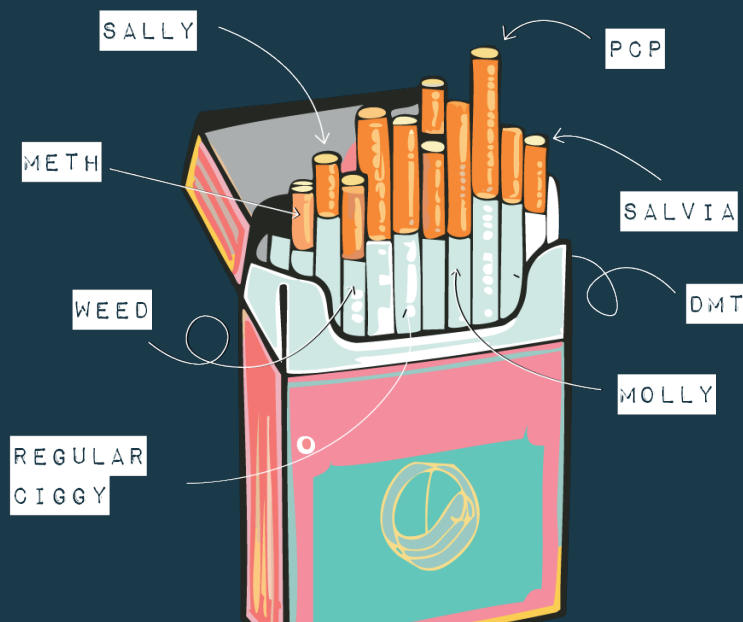
JOSH BRENER JOINS HARVEY GUILLÉN IN 'THAT FRIEND' COMEDY

deadline.com • August 2024

HARVEY GUILLÉN TO TOPLINE 'THAT FRIEND' COMEDY

deadline.com • July 2024

The Magical
Mystery
tour



Everyone has...

THAT FRIEND

Contact

A Bolo Production in association
with Straw Hut Media

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